

Billing Matters Reports

Introduction

This whitepaper answers questions about the reporting capabilities of Billing Matters. These particular reports are covered:

Hours billed by timekeeper for a given period of time.

Hours billed by timekeeper for a given period of time by matter.

Billings in dollars by timekeeper for a given period of time.

Billings in dollars by timekeeper for a given period of time by matter.

Collected Fees by timekeeper for a given period of time.

Collected Fees by timekeeper for a given period of time by matter.

Accounts Receivable by timekeeper for a given period of time.

Accounts Receivable by timekeeper for a given period of time by matter.

Flat Fee Case Reporting

Profitability Reports

As is often the case, the devil is in the details. It is important to understand what the various reports can and cannot do. The output and usefulness of each report depends on the available filtering and sorting options. With this in mind, I have tested each report and have set forth the relevant options.

In order to facilitate the set up and use of each report, I have also documented the locations and option settings needed to produce the results.



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Time Reports

Hours billed by timekeeper for a period of time

Name: Productivity

One row per Staff showing hours

Type: Standard

Location: Main Menu | Report | Standard Reports | Staff Tab

Options: All TM Date Ranges: Current/Last/Next Wk/Mo/Qtr/Yr, Last +
By Staff (Timekeeper), Responsible or Department

Columns:

Staff Name	Hrs Worked	Billable Hrs	Non-Bill Hrs	Productivity %
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Option 2 for above

Name: Recap of Hours

Lists hours for each Staff and by each day for a period with totals

Type: Standard

Location: Main Menu | Report | Standard Reports | Staff Tab

Options: All TM Date Ranges: Current/Last/Next Wk/Mo/Qtr/Yr, Last +
By Staff (Timekeeper), Responsible or Department

Columns:

Staff	Date	Billable	Non-Billable	Duration (Hrs)
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Hours billed by timekeeper for a period of time by matter

Name: Hours by Staff by Matter

A custom report that can be imported into Billing Matters and customized

Type: Custom

Location: Main Menu | Report | Billing

Options: Filter by From and To Dates, Billed or Unbilled

Columns: Customizable – Staff Matter Hours Value



Billings Reports

Billings in dollars by timekeeper for a period

Name: Profitability Report by Staff
Type: Standard
Location: Main Menu | Report | Standard Reports | Staff Tab
Options: Options tab | Sort by: Staff
Filter by Date Ranges, Billed or Unbilled

Columns:

Fees Worked (hrs x rate) Billings Profit% Hours Hrs Billed Eff. Rate

Billings in dollars by timekeeper for a period by matter

Name: Does not exist but can be created using Report Designer
Type: Custom
Location: Billing List
Options: Enter a Date Range, Time / Expense / Both
Subtotals by Staff and by Matter

Columns: Your choice from Billing record, e.g.:
Staff Matter Hours \$ Billed

Collected Fees Reports

Collected Fees by timekeeper for a period

Name: Receipt Allocation Report
Type: Standard
Location: Main Menu | Report | Standard Reports | Transactions tab
Options: Filter by Date Ranges, Group by Orig./Resp./Other/None
(Must set the Group By option to None to produce Staff subtotals.)

Columns:

Staff Fees Billed/Paid Expenses Billed/Paid Total Billed/Paid

Collected Fees by timekeeper for a period by matter

This specific report is not available, but there is a report that shows Collected Fees by Matter by Staff. Subtotals are for each Matter. Staff subtotals are only within each Matter.

Name: Receipts by Fee Allocation
Type: Standard
Location: Main Menu | Report | Standard Reports | Transactions tab



Options: Choose: Sort By Matter, Then By Staff
or: Sort By Orig/Resp/Other, Then By Matter/Receipt Date

Columns: Matter Date Staff Role Allocation (Fees Collected)

Another report can produce a total for one Staff person showing subtotals for Matters. You would need to run this report once for each Staff since it cannot show more than one Staff.

Name: Receipt Allocation Report

Type: Standard

Location: Main Menu | Report | Standard Reports | Transactions tab

Options: Filter tab: Select a Staff person from the Staff drop-down
Options tab: Group By: <None> Sort By: Matter

Columns:

Matter (incorrectly labeled Client) Fees Billed Fees Paid Exp Billed Exp Paid
Tot Billed Tot Paid

Accounts Receivable Reports

Accounts Receivable by Timekeeper and by Period

Not available. A report can show AR by Originating or Responsible, but the numbers are not based on Timekeeper work. They are based on a Staff assigned to each Matter.

Accounts Receivable by Matter and by Period

The standard AR report can show AR by Matter by Period

Name: Aged Accounts Receivable

Type: Standard

Location: Main Menu | Report | Standard Reports | Transactions Tab

Options: Choose: Group by Originating or Responsible
(If Staff are not assigned as Orig or Resp, all Matters appear in one group. Otherwise, Matters are grouped by Orig or Resp.)
Time periods (30/60/90...) may be changed

Columns: Matter Current 30 60 90 120 180 and over Balance



Flat Fee Case Reporting

Existing Reports

The Receipts by Fee Allocation by Staff report lists collected fees allocated first by Matter and then by Staff. Fee allocations are marked up or marked down by a positive or negative percentage reflecting whether the flat fee collected was larger or smaller than the dollar value of the hours worked.

The available reports do not have the flexibility to show uncollected or excess fees. They only show allocations based on shortfalls, equality and excesses.

Name: Receipts by Fee Allocation
Type: Standard
Location: Main Menu | Report | Standard Reports | Transactions Tab
Options: Date range
Choose: Group By Matter, Sort By Staff
Columns: Date of Payment Staff \$ Allocation

Multiple Collections

Billing Matters supports billing multiple collections of matters as opposed to presenting the entire fee for all of a client's matters in one flat amount. Billing Matters supports Progress Billing that allows you to bill varying flat amounts at each billing cycle or ad hoc at any time.

Each payment received is allocated to Timekeepers whose time appears on the Invoice against which the payment is applied. The Receipts by Fee Allocation report lists the date of each payment the amount of that payment allocated to each Timekeeper.

A Timekeeper can receive a disproportionate allocation by being the only one to record time during a period in which a large flat charge was made.

If no one billed time during a period in which an Invoice was generated and a flat fee amount was charged, then the payment of that fee is allocated to no one.

The example, below, is a partial screenshot showing the allocation of three payments applied to three Invoices: \$1000 on 1/8, \$1000 on 1/16, and \$500 on 1/17.

Date	Staff	Role	Allocation
ZUNDER COLLECTION			
1/08/2008	Halomar,David B.	Biller	\$866.67
1/08/2008	Brown,Robert S.	Biller	\$333.33
1/16/2008	Brown,Robert S.	Biller	\$1,000.00
1/17/2008		Biller	\$500.00
ZUNDER COLLECTION			\$2,500.00
Grand Total			\$2,500.00



The first payment was split between two staff, the second allocated to the only staff who billed after the first Invoice, and the third was not allocated.

There is quite a bit of flexibility in how the program can be set up to address various scenarios.

Profitability Reports

The difference between the value of a Timekeeper's billable time and the amount billed for that time is reflected in Profitability reports. These reports show:

Billed Value as a percentage of Fees Worked, e.g.: %133.33

Effective Billing Rate, e.g.: \$400.00

If the amount actually collected on a Matter is equal to the amount billed, then the profitability reports may be used to allocate receipts among timekeepers.

Existing Profitability Reports

The existing reports break down profitability by Staff or by Matter, but not both in the same report.

By Staff (without breakdown by Matter)

Staff Profitability	Fees Worked	Billed Value	Profitability %
	Hours Worked	Hours Billed	Eff. Bill Rate

Or:

By Matter (without breakdown by Staff)

Billing Profitability	Fees Worked	Billed Value	Profitability %
	Hours Worked	Hours Billed	Eff. Bill Rate

Custom Profitability Reports

A custom report can break billed fees down by Staff and by Matter within Staff.

A quirk in the program requires one column for shortfall and another for excess, with a zero appearing in the inapplicable column for any single Matter.

Summary

1. Accounts Receivable numbers are collected per Matter, so they cannot be broken down by Timekeeper. You can get reports subtotaled by the Staff assigned to each Matter. Custom reports do not help here.
2. Collected Fees can be reported for all Timekeepers in one report, but not broken down by Matter within each Timekeeper. You can run a report for each Timekeeper showing his or her collections by Matter.
3. Flat fee reports show shortfalls and excesses as percentages. A custom report can be designed to show dollar amounts.
4. Profitability reports show the difference between the value of a Timekeeper's billable time and the amount billed for that time.



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